



MENTAL STRENGTH

Imposter Syndrome



Imposter Syndrome



What is Imposter syndrome?



What does it feel like?



- Impostor syndrome is the belief that you are not as competent as others perceive you to be



WHAT IMPOSTER SYNDROME FEELS LIKE

'I am going to get found out at any moment'

'I really don't belong here'

'I have no idea how I got this job'

'It must be so obvious to others that I am out of my depth'

Imposter syndrome can create fear, anxiety, stress, depression, burnout, reduced job performance and satisfaction, and can stifle future potential

Identifying Imposter Syndrome



Downplaying your
abilities and skills



Attributing your success
to external factors



Being hard
on yourself



Fear of failure



Overachieving to ensure
you are not found out



Procrastination and
perfectionism



Self-doubt

*'Even with success, you convince yourself that it was down to luck'
and so the vicious cycle continues*

Causes of Imposter Syndrome



PARENTING STYLES

Characterised by being controlling or overprotective, e.g. families that highly valued achievement.



STARTING A NEW ROLE / CHANGING COMPANIES

The pressure to achieve and succeed combined with a lack of experience can trigger feelings of inadequacy in the new environment.



PERSONALITY TRAITS

Such as low self-efficacy, perfectionism and procrastination.



SOCIAL ANXIETY DISORDER

People who feel they don't belong in social or performance situations.



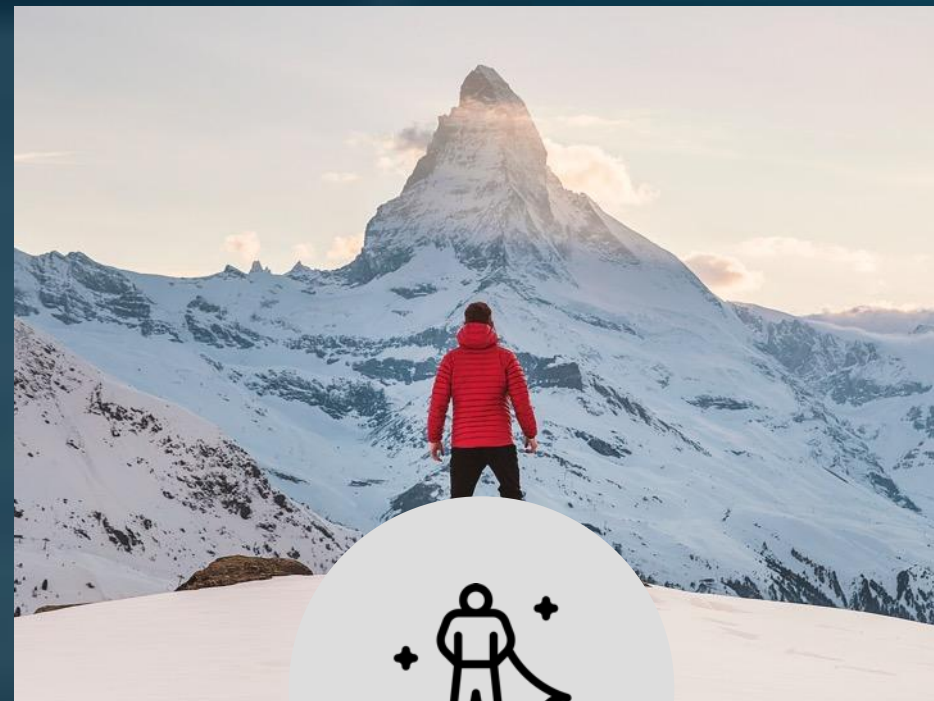
Imposter syndrome occurs in people of all backgrounds, ages and gender

Types of Imposter Syndrome



PERFECTIONIST

Never satisfied, always feels that their work could be better. Fixated on their flaws or mistakes, creating high levels of self-pressure and anxiety.



SUPERHERO

Feels compelled to push themselves to the limit, working as hard as possible, juggling multiple projects or activities.



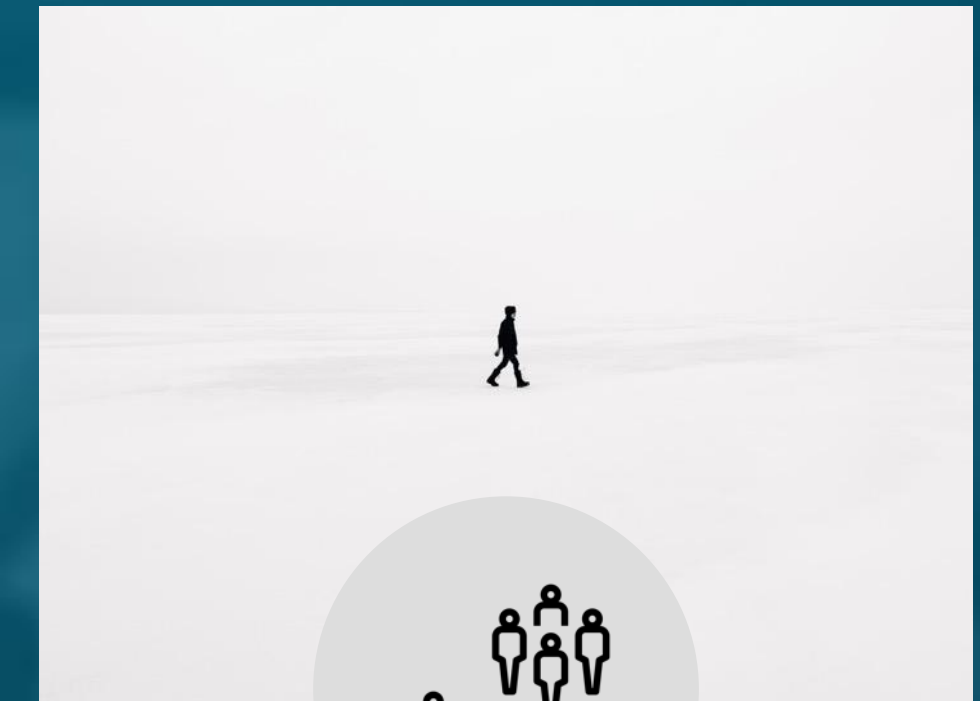
EXPERT

Always trying to learn more, is never satisfied with their level of knowledge. Highly skilled, they underrate their own expertise.



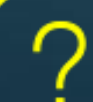
NATURAL GENIUS

Individuals who set high goals for themselves, and then feel deflated when they don't succeed on their first try.



SOLOIST

Prefers to work alone. Rejects offers of assistance, believing asking for help is a sign of weakness or incompetence.



Which type are you?

Imposter Syndrome - Impact and Prevention

An early study found that 7 in 10 adults experience Imposter Syndrome at one time in their career.

Clance PR & Matthews G, 1980s

A 2020 review of 62 studies on employed populations found prevalence rates of up to 82%, both men and women, across a range of age groups, and particularly high among ethnic minority groups.

Bravata et al



Impact - Depression and anxiety often occur alongside imposter syndrome. It can also be associated with impaired job performance, reduced job satisfaction and burnout.



Employers should be mindful of imposter syndrome/associated conditions and provide targeted training, self-directed learning, coaching and mentoring.



Employees should seek out the opportunities on offer including onboarding, orientation, training, self-learning, mentorship, coaching and career development.



Leaders/Organisations should foster a culture that rewards growth and effort rather than promoting overly competitive environments or a blame culture which can fuel imposter syndrome.

Overcoming Imposter Syndrome in the Workplace

Best Practice



Use Cognitive Restructuring: replace negative thoughts with fact



Keep a journal/Success Bank to reflect accomplishments and recognition.



Self-Assessment: Periodically review your strengths and weaknesses.



Professional Development: enhance your skills, capabilities and knowledge and keep a Skills Inventory.



Define success for the specific task based on the context.



Cultivate a growth mindset: learn from setbacks and challenges



Goal setting & Visualisation: set realistic goals and visualise success.



Seek Feedback: to gain perspective and improve self-awareness.



Celebrate your Successes: acknowledge compliments, take time to reflect on a job well done.



Mentorship: Find a mentor or coach to offer guidance.

Imposter Syndrome



EXERCISE 1

Implementing Best Practice

To effectively combat imposter syndrome, it's important to incorporate best practice into your daily/weekly/monthly routine. Here are some ways to do this using the template provided:

1

Daily Routine:

Whenever you have a negative thought about your abilities write it down. Spend 10 minutes at the end of each day reviewing this and reframing those thoughts. Respond to them as if you were advising a friend. This can provide a new perspective.

ORIGINAL THOUGHT

I have never done this before and I will fail.



REFRAMED THOUGHT

I've taken on similar tasks and been successful.

My manager criticised my work, I'm no good at my job.



My manager's criticism may be valid, I'll try to learn from it and apply their suggestions in future.

I made a mistake at work.



Mistakes happen, no-one is infallible, I'll work through this.

Imposter Syndrome



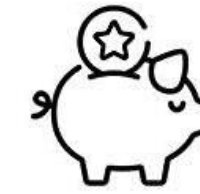
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Weekly Check-ins:



At the end of each week update your Success Bank (Exercise 1 'Self-efficacy').



Update your separate Skills Inventory to reflect formal learning you have undertaken.



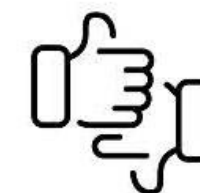
Review your strengths and weaknesses. Identify areas for improvement and acknowledge areas where you excel.

3

Monthly Review:



Schedule feedback sessions with your manager or mentor, either monthly or on completion of a significant piece of work (e.g. project/presentation).



Collectively review your strengths and weaknesses and discuss the best way to enhance your capabilities either through formal or on-the-job training.